foodpanda Bangladesh: a product teardown

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I have used foodpanda for more than eight years, so this teardown mixes that experience with public reporting. Sources are numbered in brackets and listed at the end. The suggestions are my own ideas, not company plans.

What it is

foodpanda arrived in Bangladesh in December 2013 with a team of about five people [4]. It has grown well beyond restaurant delivery. There is pandamart, which delivers groceries in about 30 minutes and launched at the end of 2020 [9], plus a Pandapro subscription, pick-up and dine-in offers [1][2], and a Home Chef programme that it says supported over 1,000 entrepreneurs in 2023 [2]. A March 2026 report, cited by a travel guide, estimated its market share at 50-60%, ahead of Foodi and Pathao Food [8]. I would treat that as a rough estimate, not an official figure.

Who it serves

It has to keep three groups happy at once. Customers want a meal at home, fast. Restaurants want extra orders without depending only on walk-ins, and foodpanda offers a sales channel, promotions and delivery in return for a commission [1]. Riders want flexible income, and the company says about 5-7% of its daily riders are women [1].

How it earns

The core is commission from restaurants [7][1], together with delivery and service fees and Pandapro subscriptions [2]. The commission is also the most argued-over part of the whole product, as the next sections show.

Against the competition

Foodi and Pathao Food are the main rivals, and travel guides say both often run cheaper promotions [8]. Pathao Food only started in 2018, five years after foodpanda [6].

There is a regulatory angle too. In January 2024 the Bangladesh Competition Commission found that foodpanda had abused its dominant position. It fined the company Tk10 lakh and told it to stop restricting restaurants from working with other platforms [3][4]. foodpanda said the order didn't fully reflect its position and that it would appeal [4][5].

What I have noticed as a long-time user

What I like most about foodpanda is speed. When I place an order, the restaurant gets it and starts preparing it straight away, which makes delivery noticeably faster than on Pathao Food.

The trade-off is that foodpanda doesn't check the order with me. Pathao Food calls back to confirm, and foodpanda does not. Anyone can misplace an order, and with no confirmation step

a mistake only shows up once the food has already been made. A phone call is slow, but it catches errors early. I would rather keep foodpanda's speed and add a lighter check, such as an in-app message, than lose the speed.

What works

foodpanda is the default food app in many cities, which gives restaurants customers and promotions they couldn't easily reach alone [1][8]. The extra services (groceries, pick-up, dine-in, subscription) give users more reasons to open the app [1][2]. And as a user I can feel the speed that comes from sending the order to the restaurant immediately.

What doesn't

The first weakness is the one I described above: without a confirmation step, wrong or missing items are hard to catch before the food is made.

The second is the tension with restaurants. One restaurant owner wrote that foodpanda asked for 28-35% commission on top of 20-25% in discounts [7]. A business-press analysis put commissions as high as 35-40% in some cases. It also argued that on a Tk100 order, a 25% commission (Tk25) can fall short of the Tk40-45 it costs to pay the rider [6]. Those are opinion pieces, not company figures, so I would treat them as one side of the story.

The competition case came from the same tension. A restaurant group alleged that foodpanda threatened higher commission or a smaller delivery area if they worked with rivals [3]. And with rivals discounting often, customers can switch easily [8].

What I would change

1. Add a quick in-app order confirmation instead of a phone call. Right after checkout, show an order summary with a short "Looks right?" tap, and call only when the order is risky: high value, a first-time customer, special instructions, or an unclear address. This keeps the speed advantage while cutting mistakes, and an in-app message costs far less than a call. To test it, show the confirmation to a random group of customers and compare wrong-order and missing-item complaints, cancellations and delivery time with a control group. The risk is that every extra step can slow ordering or annoy people, so I would watch checkout completion and time to order.

2. Give restaurants a clear dashboard. Show each restaurant its commission, its discounts and what it actually keeps per order, and offer lower rates to restaurants that prepare food fast and get good reviews. This answers the main complaint and keeps restaurants loyal without needing exclusivity, which regulators have already pushed back on [3]. I would offer it to a group of restaurants and compare their retention, their listings on rival apps and their complaints with a similar group. The risk is that lower commission means less revenue per order, so the gain has to come from keeping restaurants and growing volume.

How I would measure it

For the confirmation step, I would track order accuracy (the share of orders with a complaint about wrong or missing items), the time from order to restaurant acceptance, and checkout

completion. For the dashboard, I would watch how many restaurants stay, how many list on several platforms, and what restaurants net per order. The overall number I care about is how many customers order again within 30 days.

Sources

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